

Rogue Program

A term the media use to denote any program intended to damage programs or data, or to breach a system's security. It includes trojan horse programs, logic bombs, viruses, and more.

Search Hijacker

Any software that resets your browser's settings to point to other sites when you perform a search.

Self-Encrypting Virus

Self-encrypting viruses attempt to conceal themselves from anti-virus programs. Most anti-virus programs attempt to find viruses by looking for certain patterns of code (known as virus signatures) that are unique to each virus. Self-encrypting viruses encrypt these text strings differently with each infection to avoid detection. See Self-garbling Virus, Encrypted Virus

Self-Garbling Virus

A self-garbling virus attempts to hide from anti-virus software by garbling its own code. When these viruses spread, they change the way their code is encoded so anti-virus software cannot find them. A small portion of the virus code decodes the garbled code when activated. See Also: Self-encrypting Virus, Polymorphic Virus.

Signature

A search pattern, often a simple string of characters or bytes, expected to be found in every instance of a particular virus. Usually, different viruses have different signatures. Anti-virus scanners use signatures to locate specific viruses. Also: Virus Signatures

Slow Mailer

A slow mailer is a virus that distributes itself from victim machines via e-mail but not in the 'explosive' manner attributed to mass mailers.